INDIA CREDIT LENS · **SEP 2026 · CARDS**

Government banks are taking the card rupees

1 **More swipes, slower rupees**
Volume and value have split.

2 **Public banks take the growth**
From a much smaller share.

3 **SBI up, HDFC down**
With a high base to name.

RBI ATM, POS and card statistics · 6 slides

Swipe →

1 · CREDIT CARDS AT SHOPS

We keep swiping. The rupees aren't keeping up

+23.4% swipes

vs

+7.2% rupee value

PART	OF CUT	GROWTH	NEW
POS Transactions	—	7.2%	—
Private Sector Banks	72.7%	1.4%	14.7%
Public Sector Banks	22.6%	26.6%	71.0%

OF CUT = share of card value · **NEW** = share of the year's growth

September alone: value growth 9.1% to 7.2%. Swipes 23.5% to 23.4%.

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2 · PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS

A small share, most of the growth

22.6% vs **71.0%**

of card value — of its growth

They grew 26.6%. Private banks, with 72.7% of the value, grew 1.4%.

PART	OF CUT	GROWTH	NEW
POS Transactions	—	7.2%	—
Private Sector Banks	72.7%	1.4%	14.7%
Public Sector Banks	**22.6%**	**26.6%**	**71.0%**

September alone: their share of the growth went from 51.0% to 71.0%.

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3 · BY BANK

SBI up, HDFC Bank down

+25.2% vs **−6.7%**

SBI — HDFC Bank

A year ago HDFC Bank was growing 36.1%, so part of this is a high base.

PART	OF CUT	GROWTH
POS Transactions	—	7.2%
HDFC BANK LTD	**26.5%**	**-6.7%**
STATE BANK OF INDIA	18.3%	25.2%

September alone: HDFC Bank 0.9% to −6.7%. SBI 22.3% to 25.2%.

4 · SMALL FINANCE BANKS

Few cards, a big slice of the new ones

2.1% vs **12.3%**

of all cards — of new cards

26.94 lakh cards, up 117.4% in a year.

PART	OF CUT	GROWTH	NEW
Cards Outstanding	—	10.4%	—
Private Sector Banks	70.4%	9.6%	65.4%
Public Sector Banks	24.1%	11.0%	25.3%
Small Finance Banks	**2.1%**	**117.4%**	**12.3%**

September alone: share of new cards 11.5% to 12.3%.

RBI ATM, POS and card statistics

Why are the two moving so differently?

Private banks	**swipes +21.6%, value +1.4%**
Public banks	**swipes +13.6%, value +26.6%**

Corporate cards? Bigger tickets at public banks? Small spends moving elsewhere? We haven't tested a cause yet. What are you seeing?

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